

SQLite Optimization Migration Issues

Problem Description

When running consecutive `migrate:fresh` operations (especially `migrate:fresh` followed immediately by `migrate:fresh --seed`), you may encounter the error:

```
SQLSTATE[HY000]: General error: 11 database disk image is malformed
```

This issue is commonly caused by the SQLite optimization migration that switches the database to WAL (Write-Ahead Logging) mode.

Root Cause Analysis

The migration `001_optimize_sqlite_configuration.php` applies several SQLite PRAGMA statements that can interfere with rapid database recreation:

Key PRAGMA Settings and Their Impact:

1. `journal_mode = WAL` (Write-Ahead Logging)
 - **Critical:** Changes SQLite from default DELETE mode to WAL mode
 - **Impact:** Creates additional files (`database.sqlite-wal`, `database.sqlite-shm`)
 - **Problem:** These files can persist even after deleting the main database file
2. `synchronous = NORMAL`
 - Reduces disk sync frequency (vs FULL)
 - Can leave transactions in inconsistent state if interrupted
3. `busy_timeout = 5000`
 - Sets 5-second timeout for locked database operations
 - Could cause delays if database is locked
4. `mmap_size = 2147483648` (2GB memory mapping)
 - Uses memory mapping for large database access
 - Could affect file locking behavior
5. `auto_vacuum = incremental & incremental_vacuum`
 - Changes how SQLite manages freed space
 - Could affect database file structure

Why This Causes Migration Issues:

When you run `migrate:fresh` followed immediately by `migrate:fresh --seed`:

1. **First `migrate:fresh`:**
 - Drops tables and recreates them
 - Runs the optimization migration, switching to WAL mode
 - Creates `.sqlite-wal` and `.sqlite-shm` files
2. **Second `migrate:fresh --seed`:**

- Tries to drop all tables again
- **Problem:** WAL mode files might still be in use or corrupted
- The “database disk image is malformed” error occurs because:
 - WAL files are inconsistent with the main database
 - File system locks from previous operation still active
 - Memory-mapped regions not properly released

Solutions

1. Proper Cleanup Between Operations

```
# Close all database connections and clean up WAL files
php artisan db:wipe
rm -f database/database.sqlite*
touch database/database.sqlite
php artisan migrate:fresh --seed
```

2. Thorough Database Reset

```
# Kill any processes that might be using the database
sudo lsof +D database/ 2>/dev/null || true

# Remove all database files completely
rm -f database/database.sqlite*

# Clear Laravel caches that might hold database connections
php artisan cache:clear
php artisan config:clear
php artisan route:clear
php artisan view:clear

# Create fresh database file
touch database/database.sqlite

# Set proper permissions
chmod 664 database/database.sqlite

# Run migration with seeding
php artisan migrate:fresh --seed
```

3. Modify Optimization Migration for Development

Update the optimization migration to be less aggressive during development:

```
public function up(): void
{
    $pragmas = [
```

```

        'auto_vacuum = incremental',
        'busy_timeout = 5000',
        'cache_size = -64000',
        'foreign_keys = ON',
        'incremental_vacuum',
        'mmap_size = 2147483648',
        'page_size = 32768',
        'synchronous = NORMAL',
        'temp_store = MEMORY',
        'wal_autocheckpoint = 1000',
    ];

    // Only apply WAL mode in production
    if (app()->isProduction()) {
        $pragmas[] = 'journal_mode = WAL';
    } else {
        $pragmas[] = 'journal_mode = DELETE';
    }

    foreach ($pragmas as $pragma) {
        DB::statement("PRAGMA {$pragma}");
    }
}

```

4. Add Delay Between Operations

```

php artisan migrate:fresh
sleep 1
php artisan migrate:fresh --seed

```

Prevention

- Avoid running multiple `migrate:fresh` commands in rapid succession
- Use `migrate:fresh --seed` in a single command when possible
- Consider disabling WAL mode during development
- Always clean up WAL files when manually resetting the database

Notes

- WAL mode is excellent for production environments with concurrent access
- The issue primarily affects development workflows with frequent database resets
- WAL files (`.sqlite-wal`, `.sqlite-shm`) are automatically created and managed by SQLite
- These optimization settings significantly improve SQLite performance in production